Pentest Success Criteria Framework

Success Flavor	Core Objective	Technical Deliverable	Strategic Value (Client ROI)	Engagement Target (Select 2)
Coverage Success	Map the entire attack surface.	Comprehensive rule maps, asset inventories, and port/service matrices.	Complete clarity over unknown blind spots and unvetted exposure.	[ ] Target
Bypass Success	Traverse or circumvent perimeter controls.	Documented, reproducible exploit paths through active defenses.	Actionable blueprint to remediate configuration and control flaws.	[ ] Target
Impact Success	Demonstrate real-world business damage.	Proof of Concept (PoC) showing data exfiltration, ransomware simulation, or takeover.	Concrete evidence to secure internal budget and prioritize risk.	[ ] Target

Engagement Alignment Matrix

Use this checklist during scoping to establish execution guardrails:

- **Coverage + Bypass**: Best for mature perimeters needing assurance that every architectural path is thoroughly evaluated and tested.
- **Bypass + Impact**: Ideal for goal-oriented exercises (e.g., Red Teaming) to prove how deeply an adversary can breach defenses and the operational damage they can cause.
- **Coverage + Impact**: Suited for compliance-driven or baseline assessments checking wide asset groups while needing risk metrics to justify defensive expenditures.